

HR Interview Questions

1. What is the primary purpose of the question "Tell me about yourself"?

- A) To know your life history
- B) To judge your English fluency only
- C) To see if you can summarize your professional background and relevance to the role
- D) To know your family background

Answer: C) To see if you can summarize your professional background and relevance to the role

2. The "STAR" method for answering behavioral questions stands for:

- A) Situation, Task, Action, Result
- B) Situation, Time, Action, Review
- C) Strategy, Task, Action, Result
- D) Situation, Target, Action, Response

Answer: A) Situation, Task, Action, Result

3. When asked "What is your greatest weakness?", the best approach is to:

- A) Say you have no weaknesses
- B) Mention a weakness that is actually a strength (e.g., I work too hard)
- C) Mention a genuine weakness and the steps you are taking to improve it
- D) Mention a weakness that makes you unsuitable for the job

Answer: C) Mention a genuine weakness and the steps you are taking to improve it

4. Why do interviewers ask "Why should we hire you?"

- A) To intimidate you
- B) To see if you know the company history
- C) To understand your unique value proposition and fit for the role
- D) To check your salary expectations

Answer: C) To understand your unique value proposition and fit for the role

5. When answering "Where do you see yourself in 5 years?", you should focus on:

- A) Your plans to leave the company
- B) Your personal life goals primarily
- C) Professional growth that aligns with the company's trajectory
- D) Demanding a promotion

Answer: C) Professional growth that aligns with the company's trajectory

6. If asked about a time you failed, what is the most important part of your answer?

- A) Blaming others for the failure
- B) Denying that it was a big deal
- C) What you learned from the experience
- D) Changing the subject

Answer: C) What you learned from the experience

7. When an interviewer asks "Do you have any questions for us?", saying "No" suggests:

- A) You are fully prepared
- B) You are confident
- C) You may lack interest or didn't research the role
- D) You are polite

Answer: C) You may lack interest or didn't research the role

8. Which is the best question to ask the interviewer?

- A) What does your company do?
- B) How much vacation time do I get?
- C) Can you describe the company culture?
- D) How quickly can I get promoted?

Answer: C) Can you describe the company culture?

9. When discussing salary expectations, it is best to:

- A) Give a specific low number to get hired
- B) Ask for a million dollars
- C) Provide a research-based range

D) Refuse to answer

Answer: C) Provide a research-based range

10. "Why do you want to leave your current job?" – Which is a red flag answer?

A) I am looking for new challenges

B) I want to change industries

C) My boss is terrible and I hate my coworkers

D) I am looking for better growth opportunities

Answer: C) My boss is terrible and I hate my coworkers

11. What does "Cultural Fit" mean in an interview?

A) You share the same hobbies as the interviewer

B) Your values and behavior align with the company's core values

C) You come from the same country

D) You speak the same language

Answer: B) Your values and behavior align with the company's core values

12. In a stress interview, the interviewer's goal is primarily to:

A) Make you cry

B) Assess how you handle pressure and difficult situations

C) Show their authority

D) Pass time

Answer: B) Assess how you handle pressure and difficult situations

13. When asked to describe a conflict with a coworker, you should emphasize:

A) How the other person was wrong

B) How you avoided the person forever

C) How you resolved it professionally

D) That you won the argument

Answer: C) How you resolved it professionally

14. "What motivates you?" This question is asked to:

- A) Know your hobbies
- B) Understand what drives your performance and productivity
- C) Check if you need money
- D) See if you are lazy

Answer: B) Understand what drives your performance and productivity

15. If you don't know the answer to a technical question, the best response is:

- A) Guess wildly
- B) Lie
- C) Admit you don't know but explain how you would find out
- D) Stay silent

Answer: C) Admit you don't know but explain how you would find out

16. What is the appropriate attire for a formal job interview?

- A) Jeans and T-shirt
- B) Business Professional (Suit/Tie/Formal wear)
- C) Party wear
- D) Gym clothes

Answer: B) Business Professional (Suit/Tie/Formal wear)

17. When asked about a gap in your employment, you should:

- A) Lie about the dates
- B) Explain it honestly and highlight any productive activities during that time
- C) Refuse to discuss it
- D) Blame the economy

Answer: B) Explain it honestly and highlight any productive activities during that time

18. Ideally, how early should you arrive for an in-person interview?

- A) 1 hour before
- B) 10-15 minutes before

C) Exactly on time

D) 5 minutes late

Answer: B) 10-15 minutes before

19. Body language in an interview should convey:

A) Aggression

B) Nervousness

C) Confidence and Engagement

D) Boredom

Answer: C) Confidence and Engagement

20. "Tell me about a time you showed leadership." This can be answered by:

A) Only if you were a manager

B) Describing a situation where you took initiative or guided others

C) Saying you are a natural born leader

D) Listing your titles

Answer: B) Describing a situation where you took initiative or guided others

21. Which of the following is a "Behavioral" interview question?

A) What is your weakness?

B) Tell me about a time you handled a difficult client.

C) Where did you go to college?

D) Do you know Java?

Answer: B) Tell me about a time you handled a difficult client.

22. "What are your salary requirements?" If you are unsure, a safe tactic is to:

A) Ask "What is the budget for this role?"

B) Say "I work for free"

C) Say "Whatever you pay everyone else"

D) Walk out

Answer: A) Ask "What is the budget for this role?"

23. When asked "What is your biggest achievement?", focus on:

- A) High school grades
- B) A relevant professional accomplishment with measurable results
- C) Winning a video game
- D) Something personal and irrelevant

Answer: B) A relevant professional accomplishment with measurable results

24. If the interviewer asks an illegal question (e.g., about religion or family planning), you can:

- A) Answer angrily
- B) Politely decline to answer or steer the conversation back to job relevance
- C) Leave immediately
- D) Lie

Answer: B) Politely decline to answer or steer the conversation back to job relevance

25. What is an "Elevator Pitch"?

- A) A sales pitch for elevators
- B) A 30-60 second summary of who you are and what you offer
- C) A long speech about your life
- D) A pitch to raise salary

Answer: B) A 30-60 second summary of who you are and what you offer

26. To prepare for "What do you know about our company?", you should:

- A) Read the "About Us" page and recent news
- B) Guess
- C) Ask the interviewer
- D) Say you know nothing

Answer: A) Read the "About Us" page and recent news

27. "Are you willing to relocate?" If you are not, the best answer is:

- A) "No, never."

- B) "I prefer to stay in this location, but I am open to travel." (if true)
- C) "Yes" (and then refuse later)
- D) "Maybe if you pay me a lot."

Answer: B) "I prefer to stay in this location, but I am open to travel." (if true)

28. When handling a panel interview (multiple interviewers), you should:

- A) Focus only on the most senior person
- B) Make eye contact with everyone while answering
- C) Look at the floor
- D) Ask them to leave

Answer: B) Make eye contact with everyone while answering

29. "What is your ideal work environment?" You should describe:

- A) A place where no one works
- B) An environment that matches the company's culture
- C) Working from bed
- D) A noisy party atmosphere

Answer: B) An environment that matches the company's culture

30. Which is a soft skill?

- A) Java Programming
- B) Communication
- C) Accounting
- D) Machine Operation

Answer: B) Communication

31. Which is a hard skill?

- A) Teamwork
- B) Data Analysis
- C) Adaptability
- D) Empathy

Answer: B) Data Analysis

32. When asked about handling stress, a good answer involves:

- A) "I never get stressed."
- B) "I panic."
- C) Mentioning coping mechanisms like prioritization, breaks, or exercise
- D) "I quit."

Answer: C) Mentioning coping mechanisms like prioritization, breaks, or exercise

33. A "Situational" interview question often starts with:

- A) "Tell me about yourself..."
- B) "What would you do if..."
- C) "Where did you study..."
- D) "Do you have questions..."

Answer: B) "What would you do if..."

34. The best way to close an interview is to:

- A) Run out
- B) Reiterate your interest and ask about next steps
- C) Ask for the job immediately
- D) Say nothing

Answer: B) Reiterate your interest and ask about next steps

35. "Can you work under pressure?" The best response is:

- A) "No."
- B) "Yes, and here is an example..."
- C) "I try to avoid pressure."
- D) "I don't know."

Answer: B) "Yes, and here is an example..."

36. If asked about your hobbies, you should:

- A) List everything you do
- B) Mention hobbies that show positive traits (e.g., team sports, reading)
- C) Say you have no life outside work
- D) Mention illegal activities

Answer: B) Mention hobbies that show positive traits (e.g., team sports, reading)

37. "Why is there a gap in your resume?"

- A) "I was in jail." (Unless true and you want to explain)
- B) "I just didn't want to work."
- C) "I took time to upskill/care for family/travel."
- D) "Mind your business."

Answer: C) "I took time to upskill/care for family/travel."

38. The follow-up email after an interview should be sent within:

- A) 24 hours
- B) 1 week
- C) 1 month
- D) Never

Answer: A) 24 hours

39. "What makes you angry?"

- A) "Everything."
- B) "Stupid people."
- C) "Inefficiency or lack of integrity, but I handle it constructively."
- D) "My boss."

Answer: C) "Inefficiency or lack of integrity, but I handle it constructively."

40. When asked to rate yourself on a scale of 1-10, it is generally safer to:

- A) Say 10 (Perfection)
- B) Say 1 (Modesty)
- C) Say an 8 or 9 and explain room for growth

D) Refuse to rate

Answer: C) Say an 8 or 9 and explain room for growth

41. "How do you handle criticism?"

A) "I get angry."

B) "I ignore it."

C) "I appreciate it as an opportunity to improve."

D) "I cry."

Answer: C) "I appreciate it as an opportunity to improve."

42. "What does success mean to you?"

A) "Making lots of money."

B) "Achieving goals and adding value to the company."

C) "Retiring early."

D) "Having power."

Answer: B) "Achieving goals and adding value to the company."

43. If asked about a time you disagreed with a boss:

A) Say you never disagree.

B) Focus on the argument.

C) Explain how you voiced your opinion respectfully and accepted the final decision.

D) Say the boss was an idiot.

Answer: C) Explain how you voiced your opinion respectfully and accepted the final decision.

44. "Are you a team player?"

A) "No, I work alone."

B) "Yes, I enjoy collaborating to achieve common goals."

C) "Only if I am the leader."

D) "I prefer not to deal with people."

Answer: B) "Yes, I enjoy collaborating to achieve common goals."

45. Which of these is a "Transferable Skill"?

- A) Coding in a specific proprietary language
- B) Problem Solving
- C) Knowing the office door code
- D) Using a specific machine

Answer: B) Problem Solving

46. "What is your dream job?"

- A) "This job." (If unrelated, sounds fake)
- B) "Being a rockstar."
- C) A role that relates to the skills and path of the job you are applying for.
- D) "Not working."

Answer: C) A role that relates to the skills and path of the job you are applying for.

47. "Who is your role model?" This answers reveals:

- A) Your values and what you aspire to be
- B) Your favorite celebrity
- C) Your age
- D) Your political views

Answer: A) Your values and what you aspire to be

48. If the interviewer is aggressive, you should:

- A) Be aggressive back
- B) Stay calm and professional
- C) Cry
- D) Leave

Answer: B) Stay calm and professional

49. "Describe yourself in one word." You should choose:

- A) "Lazy"
- B) "Expensive"

C) A positive attribute relevant to the job (e.g., "Reliable", "Creative")

D) "Confused"

Answer: C) A positive attribute relevant to the job (e.g., "Reliable", "Creative")

50. "How do you prioritize work?"

A) "I do whatever I feel like."

B) "I use matrices like Urgent/Important to schedule tasks."

C) "I wait for the deadline."

D) "I ask someone else."

Answer: B) "I use matrices like Urgent/Important to schedule tasks."

51. "Are you overqualified for this job?"

A) "Yes."

B) "No, because I am still learning."

C) "I have strong skills, but I am looking for the specific challenges this role offers."

D) "Maybe."

Answer: C) "I have strong skills, but I am looking for the specific challenges this role offers."

52. "What do you like least about your last job?"

A) "The low pay."

B) "The boss."

C) "Lack of challenges or opportunities for growth."

D) "The work."

Answer: C) "Lack of challenges or opportunities for growth."

53. When answering "Tell me about a mistake you made", ensure you include:

A) Who caused it

B) How you fixed it and prevented recurrence

C) That it wasn't your fault

D) That it was a tiny mistake

Answer: B) How you fixed it and prevented recurrence

54. "How do you handle repetitive tasks?"

A) "I hate them."

B) "I find ways to automate them or maintain focus on quality."

C) "I sleep."

D) "I ignore them."

Answer: B) "I find ways to automate them or maintain focus on quality."

55. "What are your salary expectations?" (Freshers)

A) "As per industry standards."

B) "10 Lakhs."

C) "I don't need money."

D) "Whatever you give."

Answer: A) "As per industry standards." (or "Negotiable")

56. "Why do you want this job?"

A) "I need money."

B) "My parents told me to apply."

C) "I am passionate about [Industry/Role] and admire this company."

D) "It's close to my house."

Answer: C) "I am passionate about [Industry/Role] and admire this company."

57. "What is your management style?" (For leaders)

A) "Micromanagement."

B) "Hands-off."

C) "Situational/Collaborative."

D) "Dictatorial."

Answer: C) "Situational/Collaborative."

58. "Are you willing to travel?"

A) "No."

- B) "Yes, as required by the job."
- C) "Only to exotic places."
- D) "Why?"

Answer: B) "Yes, as required by the job."

59. "What differentiates you from other candidates?"

- A) "I am smarter."
- B) "They are bad."
- C) "My unique combination of skills [X, Y] and experience in [Z]."
- D) "I don't know them."

Answer: C) "My unique combination of skills [X, Y] and experience in [Z]."

60. "How quickly can you join?"

- A) "Tomorrow." (If true)
- B) "I need 6 months."
- C) "After my notice period of [X] days."
- D) "Whenever."

Answer: C) "After my notice period of [X] days."

61. Which is NOT a good tip for a virtual interview?

- A) Check internet connection
- B) Dress formally
- C) Sit in a dark room
- D) Look at the camera

Answer: C) Sit in a dark room

62. If you are late to an interview:

- A) Go home
- B) Inform the recruiter as soon as possible and apologize
- C) Pretend you are on time
- D) Blame the traffic profusely

Answer: B) Inform the recruiter as soon as possible and apologize

63. "What was the last book you read?" This assesses:

- A) Your literacy
- B) Your intellectual curiosity and continuous learning
- C) Your political views
- D) Your eyesight

Answer: B) Your intellectual curiosity and continuous learning

64. "Do you prefer working independently or in a team?"

- A) "Ideally a mix of both."
- B) "Alone."
- C) "Only team."
- D) "Neither."

Answer: A) "Ideally a mix of both."

65. "Give an example of your creativity."

- A) "I paint."
- B) "I solved a complex work problem using a novel approach."
- C) "I lie well."
- D) "I dress colorfully."

Answer: B) "I solved a complex work problem using a novel approach."

66. "What are you passionate about?"

- A) "Sleeping."
- B) "Technology/Helping people/etc." (Work relevant)
- C) "Money."
- D) "Beer."

Answer: B) "Technology/Helping people/etc." (Work relevant)

67. "How do you stay updated in your field?"

- A) "I don't."
- B) "I read blogs, take courses, and attend webinars."
- C) "My boss tells me things."
- D) "I guess."

Answer: B) "I read blogs, take courses, and attend webinars."

68. "What creates a good team?"

- A) "Communication, trust, and shared goals."
- B) "Everyone doing what I say."
- C) "No work."
- D) "Good food."

Answer: A) "Communication, trust, and shared goals."

69. "Describe a time you dealt with a difficult customer."

- A) "I yelled back."
- B) "I hung up."
- C) "I listened, empathized, and found a solution."
- D) "I ignored them."

Answer: C) "I listened, empathized, and found a solution."

70. The "Tell me about yourself" answer should be approximately:

- A) 30 seconds
- B) 2-3 minutes
- C) 10 minutes
- D) 1 word

Answer: B) 2-3 minutes

71. "If you were an animal, what would you be?" This tests:

- A) Your biology knowledge
- B) Your personality and creativity
- C) Your favorite pet

D) Nothing

Answer: B) Your personality and creativity

72. "How do you ensure quality in your work?"

A) "I check it once."

B) "I double-check work and use checklists."

C) "I hope for the best."

D) "I don't make mistakes."

Answer: B) "I double-check work and use checklists."

73. "What is your biggest fear?"

A) "Spiders." (Too personal)

B) "Stagnation or not meeting my potential."

C) "You."

D) "Work."

Answer: B) "Stagnation or not meeting my potential."

74. "How do you handle multiple deadlines?"

A) "I panic."

B) "I multitask poorly."

C) "I prioritize and communicate status."

D) "I miss them."

Answer: C) "I prioritize and communicate status."

75. "What software/tools are you proficient in?"

A) List relevant tools (Excel, Python, etc.)

B) "All of them."

C) "None."

D) "Candy Crush."

Answer: A) List relevant tools (Excel, Python, etc.)

76. "Why should we NOT hire you?" (Tricky)

A) "I am lazy."

B) "I am perfect."

C) "If you want someone who is [opposite of your style], I might not be the fit."

D) "You should hire me."

Answer: C) "If you want someone who is [opposite of your style], I might not be the fit."

77. "Have you ever been fired?"

A) Lie

B) "Yes, let me explain what I learned."

C) "No." (If true)

D) B or C

Answer: D) B or C

78. "What do you do if you disagree with a decision?"

A) "Sabotage it."

B) "Support it once the decision is made."

C) "Complain."

D) "Quit."

Answer: B) "Support it once the decision is made."

79. "What makes you uncomfortable?"

A) "Work."

B) "Unethical behavior."

C) "Chairs."

D) "Talking."

Answer: B) "Unethical behavior."

80. "Are you a risk taker?"

A) "Yes, calculated risks."

B) "No, never."

C) "I gamble."

D) "I don't know."

Answer: A) "Yes, calculated risks."

81. "How long do you expect to work here?"

A) "Until I find something better."

B) "As long as I am contributing and growing."

C) "1 year."

D) "Forever."

Answer: B) "As long as I am contributing and growing."

82. "What are your hobbies?"

A) "Watching TV."

B) "Reading, Hiking, Coding."

C) "Drinking."

D) "Sleep."

Answer: B) "Reading, Hiking, Coding."

83. "Do you have any blind spots?"

A) "No."

B) "Yes, sometimes I focus too much on details."

C) "I am blind."

D) "I don't think so."

Answer: B) "Yes, sometimes I focus too much on details."

84. "If you won the lottery, would you still work?"

A) "No way."

B) "Yes, because I enjoy the challenge/contribution."

C) "Maybe."

D) "I would buy the company."

Answer: B) "Yes, because I enjoy the challenge/contribution."

85. "How do you handle boredom?"

- A) "I play games."
- B) "I seek new tasks or optimize current ones."
- C) "I sleep."
- D) "I leave."

Answer: B) "I seek new tasks or optimize current ones."

86. "What is your favorite website?"

- A) "Facebook."
- B) "LinkedIn/TechCrunch/Industry related."
- C) "Netflix."
- D) "None."

Answer: B) "LinkedIn/TechCrunch/Industry related."

87. "How do you define hard work?"

- A) "Working 20 hours a day."
- B) "Doing what is required efficiently and effectively."
- C) "Sweating."
- D) "Struggling."

Answer: B) "Doing what is required efficiently and effectively."

88. "If I call your current boss, what will they say about you?"

- A) "They hate me."
- B) "They will say I am hardworking and reliable."
- C) "Don't call them."
- D) "I don't know."

Answer: B) "They will say I am hardworking and reliable."

89. "What annoys you about coworkers?"

- A) "Their breathing."

B) "Lack of accountability."

C) "Everything."

D) "Nothing."

Answer: B) "Lack of accountability."

90. "Can you relocate?"

A) "No."

B) "Yes."

C) "Maybe."

D) Depends on the situation (Honest Answer)

Answer: D) Depends on the situation (Honest Answer)

91. "What motivates you to do a good job?"

A) "Fear of firing."

B) "Personal satisfaction and professional pride."

C) "Bonus."

D) "Nothing."

Answer: B) "Personal satisfaction and professional pride."

92. "How do you handle change?"

A) "I resist it."

B) "I adapt quickly and look for the positives."

C) "I cry."

D) "I ignore it."

Answer: B) "I adapt quickly and look for the positives."

93. "What are your strengths?"

A) "I am Superman."

B) "Adaptability, Leadership, Technical skills."

C) "Eating."

D) "Sleeping."

Answer: B) "Adaptability, Leadership, Technical skills."

94. "What was your biggest failure?"

A) "I don't fail."

B) "A specific project failure and the lesson learned."

C) "My life."

D) "Forgetting lunch."

Answer: B) "A specific project failure and the lesson learned."

95. "Who are our competitors?"

A) "I don't know."

B) "Google." (If applying to a search engine)

C) [List actual competitors based on research]

D) "You have none."

Answer: C) [List actual competitors based on research]

96. "What is your notice period?"

A) "None."

B) "2 months." (State actual)

C) "I can leave without telling."

D) "1 year."

Answer: B) "2 months." (State actual)

97. "Are you open to overtime?"

A) "No."

B) "Yes, occasionally when deadlines require it."

C) "I love working 24/7."

D) "Only if paid double."

Answer: B) "Yes, occasionally when deadlines require it."

98. "Do you lie?"

- A) "Never."
- B) "Only to protect feelings, but never in business integrity."
- C) "Yes, all the time."
- D) "Sometimes."

Answer: B) "Only to protect feelings, but never in business integrity."

99. "What was the last project you led?"

- A) "I haven't."
- B) "Describe a project using STAR."
- C) "School project."
- D) "Home renovation."

Answer: B) "Describe a project using STAR."

100. "Any final words?"

- A) "Hire me."
- B) "Thank you for the opportunity."
- C) "Bye."
- D) "When do I start?"

Answer: B) "Thank you for the opportunity."